

ITEM WISE EDITORIAL ... 28th June, 2019



Security Council
United Nations



UNSC HIGH TABLE ... CLEAN SLATE CANDIDATE FROM INDIA!



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EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

28th JUNE, 2019

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At the high table

India must think big as it takes a step towards a non-permanent seat on the UNSC

By winning the unanimous endorsement of the 54-nation Asia-Pacific Group at the United Nations Security Council, India has cleared an important hurdle in its quest for a non-permanent seat for 2023-22. The decision of the grouping this week was taken as India was the sole candidate for the post. In the next step, all 193 members of the UN General Assembly will vote for five non-permanent seats in June 2020, when India will need to show the support of at least 129 countries to go through to the UNSC. It will then occupy the seat at the UNSC for a two-year period, as it has previously on seven occasions since 1950-51. There are several reasons why India decided to pursue its candidature for 2023-22. The government at the time had felt it was necessary to have India's voice at the high table as many times as possible, and therefore began the process for another seat shortly after it had ended its previous tenure in 2003-2002. By rotation, that seat would have reached India only in the 2030s, and India had to reach out to Afghanistan, which had put in its bid already for the 2023-22 slot, to request it to withdraw. Afghanistan did so because of the special relationship between the two countries. India has a unique role to play at the UNSC, given the near-complete polarisation among the permanent members (P-5 nations), with the U.S., the U.K. and France on one side, and Russia and China on the other. India's ability to work with both sides is well known. The year 2022 also has a sentimental value attached to it, as it marks the 75th year of India's independence, and a place at the UNSC would no doubt add to the planned celebrations that year. Since 2003, when it first announced the bid, the government has run a quiet but consistent campaign towards this goal.

It is significant that despite the poor state of bilateral relations with Pakistan, and the many challenges India has faced from China at the UN, both the countries graciously agreed to the nomination. From this point on, it is necessary for the government to think beyond the campaign for the UNSC, and work out a comprehensive strategy for what it plans to do with the seat. In the past, India has earned a reputation for "fence-sitting" by abstaining on votes when it was required to take a considered stand on principle, and the seat will be a chance to undo that image. Given the twin challenges of a rising China, and the U.S. receding from its UN responsibilities, India must consider how it will strengthen the multi-lateral world order amid frequent unilateral moves by both the world powers. An even bigger challenge will be to nudge all five permanent members on the one issue they have unitedly resisted: towards the reform and expansion of the UNSC, which would include India's claim to a permanent seat at the high table.

India seat endorsed: how are countries elected?

EXPRESSNEWS SERVICE
MUMBAI, JUNE 26

INDIA'S CANDIDATURE for a non-permanent seat in the Security Council has been endorsed unanimously by the Asia-Pacific Group (APG) unanimously endorses India's candidature for a non-permanent seat of the Security Council for a 2-year term in 2023/22. India's permanent representative at the UN, Syed Abbaruddin tweeted.

10 countries, 5 seats

The endorsement means that India has a "clean slate" candidature — that is there is no other contestant from the group — for the elections that will be held for five non-permanent members next year, for the 2021-22 term.

Each year, the General Assembly elects five non-permanent members out of a total of 10, for a two-year term. These 10 seats are distributed among the regions thus: five for African and Asian countries; one for Eastern European countries; two for Latin American and Caribbean countries; two for Western European and other countries.

Of the five seats for Africa and Asia, three are for Africa and two for Asia; there is an informal understanding between the two groups to reserve one for an Arab country. The Africa and Asia-Pacific group takes turns every two years to put up an Arab candidate.

Elections for terms beginning in even-numbered years select two African members, and one each within Eastern Europe, Asia-Pacific, and Latin America and the Caribbean. Terms beginning in odd-numbered years consist of two Western European and Other members, and one each from Asia-Pacific,

Africa, and Latin America and the Caribbean.

Asian contests

Unlike Africa, which has formalised a system of rotation of its three seats according to the region, the Asia-Pacific grouping often sees contests. Last year, there was a contest between Maldives and Indonesia.

Irrespective of whether a country is a "clean slate" candidate and has been endorsed by its group, it needs to secure the votes of two-thirds of the members present and voting at the General Assembly session (a minimum of 129 votes if all 193 member states participate). Formal balloting takes place at elections to all the main UN bodies.

When contested, the elections for non-permanent seats can be fraught and can go on for several rounds. In 1975, there was a contest between India and Pakistan, which went to eight rounds. Pakistan won the seat

that year. In 1996, India lost a contest to Japan.

India has been a non-permanent member of the Security Council eight times previously: 1950-51, 1967-68, 1972-73, 1977-78, 1984-85, 1991-92 and 2011-12. For the 2011-12 term, India won 187 of 190 votes after Kazakhstan stood down from its candidacy.

The 55 countries that comprise the Asia-Pacific group are: Afghanistan, Bahrain, Bangladesh, Bhutan, Brunei, Cambodia, China, Cyprus, North Korea, South Korea, Fiji, India, Indonesia, Iran, Iraq, Japan, Jordan, Kazakhstan, Kiribati, Kuwait, Kyrgyzstan, Laos, Lebanon, Malaysia, Maldives, Marshall Islands, Micronesia, Mongolia, Myanmar, Nauru, Nepal, Oman, Pakistan, Palau, Papua New Guinea, Philippines, Qatar, Samoa, Saudi Arabia, Singapore, Solomon Islands, Sri Lanka, Syria, Tajikistan, Thailand, Timor-Leste, Tonga, Turkey, Turkmenistan, Tuvalu, UAE, Uzbekistan, Vanuatu, Vietnam, and Yemen.



The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM OF COURAGE

27th June, 2019

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GS II ... International Relations

Important International institutions, agencies and fora- their structure, mandate.

DRAFT QUESTION

THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1858

28th June, 2019



44 At the high table

India must think big as it takes a step towards a non-permanent seat on the UNSC

By winning the unanimous endorsement of the 55-nation Asia-Pacific Group at the United Nations Security Council, India has cleared an important hurdle in its quest for a non-permanent seat for 2021-22. The decision of the grouping this week was taken as India was the sole candidate for the post. In the next step, all 193 members of the UN General Assembly will vote for five non-permanent seats in June 2020, when India will need to show the support of at least 129 countries to go through to the UNSC. It will then occupy the seat at the UNSC for a two-year period, as it has previously on seven occasions since 1950-51. There are several reasons why India decided to pursue its candidature for 2021-22. The government at the time had felt it was necessary to have India's voice at the high table as many times as possible, and therefore began the process for another seat shortly after it had ended its previous tenure in 2011-2012. By rotation, that seat would have reached India only in the 2030s, and India had to reach out to Afghanistan, which had put in its bid already for the 2021-22 slot, to request it to withdraw. Afghanistan did so because of the special relationship between the two countries. India has a unique role to play at the UNSC, given the near-complete polarisation among the permanent members (P-5 nations), with the U.S., the U.K. and France on one side, and Russia and China on the other. India's ability to work with both sides is well known. The year 2022 also has a sentimental value attached to it, as it marks the 75th year of India's Independence, and a place at the UNSC would no doubt add to the planned celebrations that year. Since 2013, when it first announced the bid, the government has run a quiet but consistent campaign towards this goal.

44 At the high table

It is significant that despite the poor state of bilateral relations with Pakistan, and the many challenges India has faced from China at the UN, both the countries graciously agreed to the nomination. From this point on, it is necessary for the government to think beyond the campaign for the UNSC, and work out a comprehensive strategy for what it plans to do with the seat. In the past, India has earned a reputation for 'fence-sitting' by abstaining on votes when it was required to take a considered stand on principle, and the seat will be a chance to undo that image. Given the twin challenges of a rising China, and the U.S. receding from its UN responsibilities, India must consider how it will strengthen the multilateral world order amid frequent unilateral moves by both the world powers. An even bigger challenge will be to nudge all five permanent members on the one issue they have unitedly resisted: towards the reform and expansion of the UNSC, which would include India's claim to a permanent seat at the high table.

44 India endorsed for non-permanent seat at UNSC: how are countries elected?

The endorsement means that India has a “clean slate” candidature – that is there is no other contestant from the group – for the elections that will be held for five non-permanent members next year, for the 2021-22 term.

India’s candidature for a non-permanent seat in the Security Council has been endorsed unanimously by the Asia Pacific group, which comprises 55 countries, including Pakistan. “A unanimous step. Asia-Pacific Group @UN unanimously endorses India’s candidature for a non-permanent seat of the Security Council for a 2-year term in 2021/22,” India’s permanent representative at the UN, Syed Akbaruddin tweeted.

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Each year, the General Assembly elects five non-permanent members out of a total of 10, for a two-year term. These 10 seats are distributed among the regions thus: five for African and Asian countries; one for Eastern European countries; two for Latin American and Caribbean countries; two for Western European and other countries.

Of the five seats for Africa and Asia, three are for Africa and two for Asia; there is an informal understanding between the two groups to reserve one for an Arab country. The Africa and Asia Pacific group takes turns every two years to put up an Arab candidate.

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PRESENT CONTEXT



Security Council
United Nations



1 India's candidature for a non-permanent seat in the Security Council has been endorsed unanimously by the Asia Pacific Group, it comprises 55 countries, including Pakistan.

2 This is for a non-permanent seat of the Security Council for a 2 year term in 2021-22.

3 The endorsement means India has a "clean slate candidate", for the elections that will be held for five non-permanent members in June 2020, for the 2021-22 term.

4 Until now, India has been a non-permanent member of the UN Security Council for 7 times, the latest in 2011-12, under the leadership of former Ambassador, Hardeep Singh Puri.

HOW DO THE UN GENERAL ASSEMBLY MEMBERS ELECTED?



I The 5 permanent members are China, Russia, USA, France and UK.

II Each year, 193 member General Assembly elects five non-permanent members for a two year term.

III The 10 non-permanent seats are distributed on a regional basis

- Five for African and Asian States
- One for Eastern European States
- Two for the Latin American and Caribbean States
- Two for Western European and other States.

IV Of the 5 seats for Asia and Africa, 3 are for Africa and 2 are for Asia. There is an informal understanding between the two groups to reserve one for the Arab Country.



TENTATIVE INDICATION OF NON-PERMANENT UN SECURITY COUNCIL MEMBERS



WHAT IS THE PROCEDURE FOR ELECTION?

- 1** Irrespective of whether a country is a “Clean Slate” candidate and has been endorsed by its group, all 193 members of the UN General Assembly will vote for five non-permanent seats in June 2020, when India will need to show the support of at least 129 countries to go to the UNSC.
- 2** Formal balloting takes place at elections to all the main UN Bodies.
- 3** When contested, the elections for non-permanent seats can go on for several rounds.
- 4** In 1975, there was a contest between India and Pakistan, which went to eight rounds. Pakistan won the seat that year.



WHY THIS ASSUMED SIGNIFICANCE?

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none">i. India felt it is necessary to have India's voice at UN High Table as many times as possible.ii. The previous tenure ended in 2011-12 and by rotation that would have reached India only in the 2030s, but India started the process for another seat shortly after its previous tenure ended.iii. India reached out to Afghanistan, which already put its bid for 2021-22. | <ul style="list-style-type: none">iv. Despite poor state of bilateral relations with Pakistan and many challenges from China, both the countries agreed to the nomination.v. There is complete polarisation among permanent members, with US, UK and France on one side and Russia and China on the other and India can nudge all five permanent members for consensus.vi. Year 2022 has sentimental value, because it marks the 75th year of India's Independence. |
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WAY FORWARD

There are twin challenges of rising China and US receding from its UN responsibilities. India must consider, how it will strengthen the multilateral world order amid frequent unilateral moves by both the world powers.



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